

IEMs - In Ear Monitors are those earphones that you squish into your ear canal, they generally come with different sized rubber tips so you can choose which size is comfortable for you.

Almost all the above types are further broken down into two sub-groups - closed back and open back. The difference that this approach creates is how the sound is perceived by the listener. Closed back earphones don't let much ambient noise in so it feels like the sound actually originates at your ears while open back earphones feel like the sound is coming from a farther source. This adds a bit of depth to the audio perception.

Microphone

While there are quite a lot of aspects to consider while buying a microphone for a professional setup, the average user has no use for all the extra pizzaz. A simple condenser mic is more than capable of picking up your voice. The further distance that you put between the mic and yourself, the higher gain the mic should have in order to pick up your voice, so either you move the mic closer to you or you invest in something more expensive, we can all see the obvious choice.

Types

Microphones can be classified based on build as well as its polarity. Polarity refers to the ability of a mic to pick up sound from a particular direction. There are microphones that pick up sound from all directions and they are aptly called omnidirectional microphones. Then there are unidirectional microphones that pick up sound from only one direction. Here are a few diagrams that show the different polarity that microphones have.

The coverage angle refers to the directions from which the sound is picked up. The angle of maximum rejection refers to which direction the sound is completely blocked from. Rear rejection refers to the ratio of sound intensity that the microphone is sensitive to when the front side is compared to the rear side. Ambient sound sensitivity is pretty self explanatory and the distance factor tells you from how far a microphone can pick up sound as compared to the omnidirectional microphone.

What to buy

When looking to buy an all-in-one printer / scanner / copier keep the following points in mind.

- 1 Spending an awful amount in a good set of speakers and not having the right environment for it is not a prudent decision.